

Contestant Number: \_\_\_\_\_

Time: \_\_\_\_\_

Rank: \_\_\_\_\_



# ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM (540)

## NATIONAL 2023 PRELIMINARY

|                      |                    |
|----------------------|--------------------|
| Presentation Points  | _____ (140 points) |
| Specification Points | _____ (20 points)  |
| TOTAL POINTS         | _____ (160 points) |

**Preparation Time: 20 minutes**

### **GENERAL GUIDELINES:**

***Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:***

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

### **DESCRIPTION:**

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

### **NATIONAL PRELIMINARY SCENARIO:**

Marie is the Chief Financial Officer (CFO) at Digital Solutions, a non-profit company. The company just received a large federal grant to set up a new location. The company needs to purchase furniture and other accessories for the new location. Marie's best friend owns an office furniture store and scheduled a dinner meeting to discuss the project. Although her friend's quote was nearly twice the closest bid, Marie agreed to purchase everything from her. To "sweeten the pot," her friend is going to give Marie a brand-new entertainment center for her home.

- What are the possible consequences of Marie's actions?
- Could this be considered unethical and a conflict of interest?
- Does this decision violate any laws or regulations?
- What procedures should be implemented to reduce similar purchasing situations in the future?

**A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.**

**Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.**